

RARING TO GO

The T20 World Cup has consistently been a platform for emerging talents to announce themselves on the global stage. Over the years, it has seen the rise of stars like Rohit Sharma, Carlos Brathwaite and Sam Curran. As we look forward to the 2024 edition, here are eight World Cup debutants who could light up this year's tournament.

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SHAMAR JOSEPH

Shamar Joseph's exploits in his debut series against Australia catapulted him to fame. The 24-year-old Guyanese bowled 12 overs straight in the Brisbane Test, taking 7/68 to help the West Indies secure its first Test win Down Under since 1997.

Joseph's clean bowling action and precision in the 'right channel' have been assets in the longer format. However, with only three T20 matches under his belt, he has yet to prove his worth in the shorter format.

Lucknow Super Giants named Joseph as the replacement for Mark Wood in the Indian Premier League 2024, where he played just one game, conceding 11.75 runs per over.

He remains wicketless in T20s and has yet to make his T20I debut, but playing in familiar Caribbean conditions, his prospects appear promising.

WILL JACKS

Will Jacks brings an X-factor to the English squad.

At 25, Jacks has already played 165 T20 matches, amassing over 4000 runs at an impressive strike rate of 160. He has four centuries and 31 fifties in the shortest format.

An aggressive top-order batter, Jacks is also a handy off-spinner, having taken 6/199 on his Test debut against Pakistan.

Jacks has played in the SA20 and Bangladesh Premier League before featuring in IPL 2024, scoring centuries in all three leagues within three months.

In 11 T20Is, he has 181 runs while striking at 150 with a highest score of 40.

With England boasting top-order options like skipper Jos Buttler, Phil Salt, Jonny Bairstow, and Harry Brook, the inclusion of Jacks could add even more flamboyance to the 2022 T20 World Cup winners.

